Beats Carry the Tape

Both IOWN sleeves close green on a flat-tape session as flagship earnings dominate. Dividend +0.17%, Growth +0.29%. FOMC holds, Powell exits with four dissents.

THE SESSION

The headline tape said almost nothing today; the print tape said almost everything. The S&P 500 finished within a hair of unchanged at 7,137.56 (−0.02%), the Nasdaq Composite added a fractional 0.04% to 24,673.90, and the Dow Industrials slipped 0.57% to 48,861.80. The Russell 2000 lost 0.60%. VIX climbed to 18.36 (+2.97%). Beneath that surface composure, the day was decisively about earnings dispersion, and IOWN's sleeves landed on the right side of it.

The Federal Reserve held the funds rate at 3.50%–3.75%, the third consecutive hold, in what is very likely Jerome Powell's final policy decision as chair. Four dissents — the highest since 1992 — split between one dovish vote for a quarter-point cut and three votes to remove the easing bias from the statement. Powell confirmed he intends to remain on the Board of Governors after his chairmanship expires May 15. Kevin Warsh advanced from the Senate Banking Committee on a 13–11 party-line vote this morning. The market reaction was muted: front-end yields ticked up, the long end held, and equities barely moved on the headline.

Where the action lived was in the IOWN reporting calendar. General Dynamics delivered a clean beat-and-raise, ADP raised guidance and authorized a $6 billion buyback, NXP Semiconductors posted what is on track to be its best single session since its 2010 IPO, and Valero added 4.59% on pre-earnings positioning into tomorrow's print. The Dividend Strategy closed +0.17%, beating DVY (−0.23%) and roughly flat SPY by a full point on the day. The Growth Portfolio added 0.29%, ahead of IUSG (−0.36%) on NXPI's gap and a recovering AI-infrastructure complex.

Energy held its bid: WTI continues to trade near $100, the Iran-Hormuz standoff remains unresolved, and refiners and integrateds saw fresh interest. Crypto-adjacent names took the day's losses — HOOD extended its post-earnings decline another 13.24%, and COIN sold off 6.37% in sympathy with Bitcoin slipping to $75,559. The Mag7 reporting block tonight (MSFT, GOOGL, META, AMZN) and QCOM's after-close print remain the day's unfinished business.

IOWN Tactical: A flat index print is not a quiet day — it is a day where dispersion does the work. Both sleeves outperformed because owned businesses delivered owned-business results.

IOWN HOLDINGS: NOTABLE MOVERS

WINNERS

NXPI +25.51% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Q1 EPS $3.05 vs $2.95 estimate on revenue of $3.18B; Q2 guide of $3.35B–$3.55B revenue and $3.29–$3.72 EPS sits well above consensus. Management reaffirmed 2027 double-digit growth and margin-expansion commitments. Automotive +6% YoY, Industrial & IoT +24%. Jefferies raised target to $300 (Buy). Largest single-session move in the name since the 2010 IPO.

ADP +7.99% — DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Q3 FY26 EPS $3.37 vs $3.30 estimate; revenue $5.94B vs $5.85B. Raised FY26 revenue growth guidance to 6–7% (from ~6%) and adjusted EPS growth to 10–11% (from 9–10%). Board authorized a $6B share repurchase program and a 10% dividend increase. Employer Services +7% with margin expansion; record retention rates.

GD +7.99% — DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Q1 EPS $4.10 vs $3.69 estimate; revenue $13.48B vs $12.73B. Raised 2026 EPS guidance to $16.45–$16.55 (from $16.10–$16.20). Q1 orders of $26.6B drove a 2-to-1 book-to-bill; backlog of $130.8B is up 47.5% YoY. Marine Systems revenue +21%, Aerospace +8.4% with 38 Gulfstream deliveries. FCF of $1.95B (192% of net earnings).

CRDO +6.05% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Recovery bid in the AI-infrastructure complex after Tuesday's 8.08% decline. Positioning is reversing into tonight's hyperscaler capex commentary, with the broader analog and connectivity sleeve participating.

VLO +4.59% — DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Pre-earnings positioning ahead of tomorrow's pre-market print. Refining margins remain elevated as the Hormuz disruption keeps WTI near $100. Diesel cracks have been particularly strong, and consensus has been revised higher into the release.

DECLINERS

HOOD –13.24% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Continuation lower after Tuesday's Q1 miss ($0.38 EPS vs $0.43 estimate) and the disclosure that crypto trading revenue fell 47% YoY. The HOOD print confirmed the structural-flow thesis: ETF ownership of digital assets is increasingly displacing direct exchange volume.

COIN –6.37% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Crypto-adjacent sympathy decline alongside HOOD's second-day weakness, with Bitcoin at $75,559 (−1.02%) and Ether ETF flows soft. The 47% YoY crypto-revenue compression at HOOD weighs on exchange-volume assumptions across the sleeve.

VST –4.55% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Independent power producer pulled back on a session of mixed AI-power positioning ahead of tonight's hyperscaler capex prints. The data-center power thesis remains intact but is rebalancing alongside the broader semiconductor-infrastructure complex.

SUPV –4.37% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Argentine financial selling off on emerging-markets risk-off as oil pressures EM importers and the rate path narrative tightens. Low-volume name; move is amplified by thin trading.

AEM –3.00% GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Gold miner declined alongside spot gold (−1.04% to $4,560.50). Capital rotated out of duration-sensitive precious-metals exposure as the Fed's hold and the FOMC's mixed dissent signal kept the rate path higher-for-longer.

HOLDINGS NEWS

QCOM reports after the close. Consensus near $2.61 EPS on $10.59B revenue; the AI-edge narrative and the Apple modem-insourcing risk are the two competing positioning vectors. The shares added 4.00% during the regular session in anticipation.

Mag7 reporting block (read-through). MSFT, GOOGL, META, and AMZN all report after close. Collective 2026 capex guidance — estimated $600B–$645B — is the cross-current that will set the next move for AMD, NVDA, TSM, MRVL, and the AI-infrastructure complex broadly. NXPI's gap today preconditions positioning to the upside.

VLO reports tomorrow pre-market. Consensus $2.97 EPS on $30.88B revenue. The four-quarter average surprise is +45%, and refining margins through Q1 favor the print.

PORTFOLIO PERFORMANCE

DIVIDEND STRATEGY ✓ BEAT BOTH

+0.17%

vs. DVY –0.23% | SPY –0.05%

GROWTH PORTFOLIO ✓ BEAT

+0.29%

vs. IUSG –0.36%

YEAR-TO-DATE

Dividend +11.41% vs DVY +8.41% / SPY +4.62%
Growth +3.84% vs IUSG +4.87%